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September 1, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. NNN-F-240C
July 19, 1974

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FLASK, LABORATORY

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers borosilicate glass flasks.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types, classes, styles, and capacities. Flasks covered by this specification shall be of the following types, classes, styles, and capacities, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Boiling.

Class 1 - Flat bottom.
Style I - Vial or tooled mouth.
Capacity - 250, 500, 1000, 3000 milliliters (ml).

Style II - Ring neck mouth.
Capacity - 500, 1000 ml.

Style III - Taper-ground (joint) mouth.
Capacity - 125, 250 ml.

Class 2 - Round bottom.
Style I - Vial or tooled mouth.
Capacity - 25, 50, 100, 200, 500 ml.

Style II - Ring neck mouth.
Capacity - 500, 1000, 2000 ml.

Style III - Taper-ground (joint) mouth.
Capacity - 50, 100, 250, 500, 1000, 2000 ml and 100 ml with long neck.

Style IV - Taper-ground (joint) mouth with pour out.
Capacity - 50, 100 ml.

Type II - Culture, Kolle design.

Type III - Distilling.

Class 1 - With side arm.
Capacity - 25, 50, 125, 250, 500, 1000 ml.

Style II - Special purpose.
Capacity - 100 ml Engler design, 250 ml Saybolt design, 300 ml Church design. 500 ml Hempel design.

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Class 2 - 3-neck, taper-ground joints.

Type IV - Erlenmeyer.

Class 1 - General purpose.
Style I - Narrow mouth.
Capacity - 25, 50, 125, 250, 500, 1000, 2000, 4000, 6000 ml.

Style II - Wide mouth.
Capacity - 250, 500, 1000 ml.

Class 2 - Taper-ground joint.
Style I - Without stopper.
Capacity - 50, 125, 250, 500 ml.

Style II - With pennyhead stopper.
Capacity - 25, 50, 125, 250, 500, 1000 ml.

Style III - Iodine determination.
Capacity - 125, 250, 500 ml.

Type V - Filtering.

Capacity - 25, 50, 125, 250, 500, 1000, 2000, 4000 ml with side arm, and 500 ml without side arm.

Type VI - Kjeldahl

Capacity - 10, 30, 100, 500, 800 ml.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

ZZ-S-751 - Stoppers, Bottle, Rubber.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Commercial Standard:

CS21 - Interchangeable Taper-Ground Joints, Stopcocks, Stoppers, and Spherical-Ground Joints.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

C 148 - Polariscopic Examination of Glass Containers.
C 162 - Definition of Terms Relating to Glass and Glass Products.
E 438 - Glasses in Laboratory Apparatus.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Glass. All flasks covered by this specification shall be of borosilicate glass conforming to type I, class A of ASTM E 438.

3.2 Design.

3.2.1 General features.

3.2.1.1 Appearance. The general appearance of the flasks shall be as illustrated in figure 1 (see 6.3).

3.2.1.2 Stoppers. The flasks shall be furnished with or without a stopper, as specified (see 6.2). If stoppered flask is furnished, it shall be fitted with the listed standard taper stopper conforming to CS 21 or the rubber stopper conforming to ZZ-S-751.

3.2.2 Graduation markings. Type IV flask, class 1, styles I and II shall have clear graduation markings, with an accuracy of plus or minus 5 percent of the overall capacity, specified in table III. Each main graduation shall be marked to show its value; intermediate graduations shall not be marked. Value figures shall be uniformly positioned in arabic numerals.

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3.2.3 Shape.

3.2.3.1 Type I. Boiling flasks shall be round with round or flat bottoms. Flat bottoms shall be in a plane perpendicular to the vertical axis through the neck of the flask. Neck of the flask shall be long or short. Long neck flasks shall terminate with a vial or tooled mouth or heavy beaded rim (ring neck). Short neck flasks may terminate with a ring neck mouth or standard taper-ground joint conforming to CS 21 or with a standard taper-ground joint with pour out conforming to CS 21. Capacity, shape, and stopper requirements shall conform to table I.

TABLE 1. Dimensions and summerized data for type I boiling flasks

Classification			Shape data			Stopper size	
							Taper-ground
Class	Style	Capacity, ml	Bottom	Neck	Mouth	Rubber	joint
1	I	250	Flat	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	4 or 5	-----
1	I	500	Flat	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	5 or 6	-----
1	I	1000	Flat	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	6 or 8	-----
1	I	3000	Flat	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	9	-----
1	II	500	Flat	Long	Ring neck	6	-----
1	II	1000	Flat	Long	Ring neck	7 or 8	-----
1	III	125	Flat	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
1	III	250	Flat	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
2	I	25	Round	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	1	-----
2	I	50	Round	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	1	-----
2	I	100	Round	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	2	-----
2	I	200	Round	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	4 or 5	-----
2	I	500	Round	Long	Vial or tooled mouth	4 or 6	-----
2	II	500	Round	Short	Ring neck	6	-----
2	II	1000	Round	Short	Ring neck	8	-----
2	II	2000	Round	Short	Ring neck	10	-----
2	III	50	Round	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	19/38
2	III	100	Round	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
2	III	250	Round	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
2	III	500	Round	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
2	III	1000	Round	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
2	III	2000	Round	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
2	III	100	Round	Long	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
2	IV	50	Round	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40
2	IV	100	Round	Short	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40

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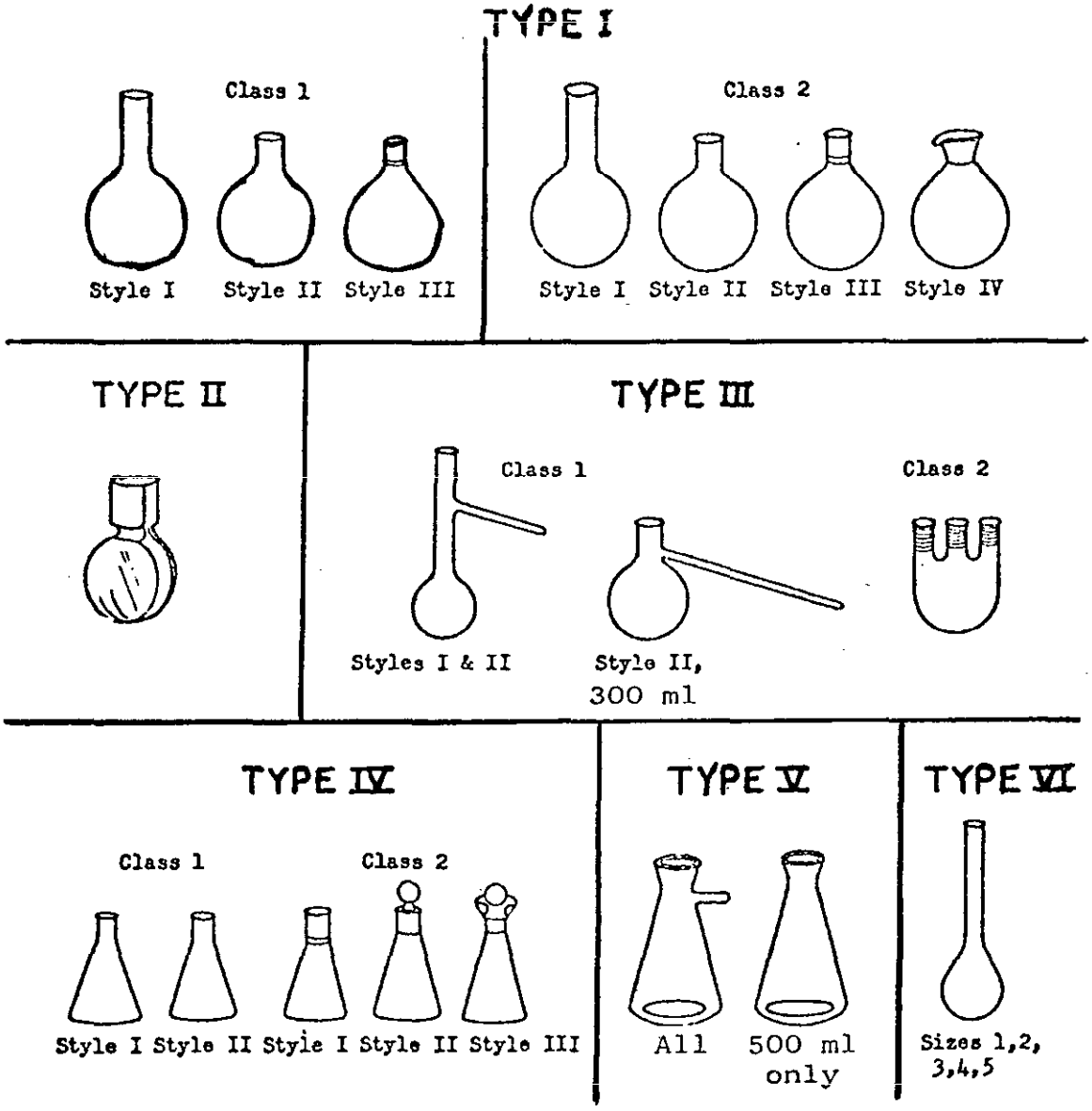


FIGURE 1. Appearance of flasks

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3.2.3.2 Type II. Culture (Kolle) flasks shall have 2 round flat sides extending from the round bottom to the mouth of the flask. One flat side shall be indented at the neck line so that when placed on its side with the indented side down, the indenture will retain approximately 100 ml of culture media. Listed capacity shall be 320 ml. The flask shall have the following dimensions, diameter 135 mm max., mouth 35 mm by 55 mm, neck constriction 7 mm.

3.2.3.3 Type III. The 25 ml and 50 ml distilling flasks may be pear-shaped; all larger sizes shall have round bottoms; the necks shall be long or short, as specified. Long neck flasks shall have side arm at 75° ± 5° (lower angle) to the neck; short neck flasks shall have side arm or taper-ground joints conforming to CS 21. Dimensions and summarized data are as shown in table II.

TABLE II. Dimensions and summarized data for type III distilling flasks

Classification			Shape data			Stopper size		Side arm data		Distance from center line of side arm to	
Class	Style	Cap., ml.	Bottom	Neck	Mouth	Rubber	Taper-ground joint	Length mm ± 3 mm	Outside diameter, mm	Mouth of neck mm	Bottom of flask mm
1	I	25	Round or pear shaped	Long	Vial	1	-----	100	7±0.5	77±3	-----
1	I	50	Round or pear shaped	Long	Vial	1	-----	100	7±0.5	77±3	-----
1	I	125	Round	Long	Vial	3	-----	100	7±0.5	----	137±3
1	I	250	Round	Long	Vial	3 or 4	-----	130	9±0.5	77±3	-----
1	I	500	Round	Long	Vial	4	-----	130	9±0.5	77±3	-----
1	I	1000	Round	Long	Vial	6	-----	180	11±0.5	77±3	-----
1	II	100	Round	Long	Vial	2	-----	100	6±0.5	----	137±3
1	II	250	Round	Long	Vial	1	-----	100	6±0.5	----	150±3
1	II	300	Round	Short	Vial	4	-----	220	12.5±1.0	----	*93±1.5
1	II	500	Round	Long	Vial	5	-----	172	8±1.0	64±3	-----
2	--	500	Round	Short	3 taper ground joints	------	24/40	---	--------	----	-----

* Distance from bottom of flask to horizontal tangent at junction of bottom of side arm to flask, inside.

3.2.3.4 Type IV. Erlenmeyer flasks shall have broad flat bottoms and conical sides extending inwardly from the bottom and terminating in a short cylindrical neck with a vial mouth or taper-ground joint conforming to CS 21. Glass stoppers shall conform to CS 21. Dimensions and summarized data shall be as shown in table III.

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TABLE III. Dimensions and summarized data for type IV Erlenmeyer flasks

Classification			Type mouth	Stopper size		Graduations (ml.)	
Class	Style	Cap., ml.		Rubber	Taper-ground joint	Graduated range (ml)	Graduated interval (ml)
1	I	25	Narrow	0	----------	10-25	5
1	I	50	Narrow	1	----------	20-50	10
1	I	125	Narrow	4 or 5	----------	50-125	25
1	I	250	Narrow	6	----------	50-200	25
1	I	500	Narrow	7	----------	100-500	50
1	I	1000	Narrow	9	----------	250-1000	50
1	I	2000	Narrow	10	----------	600-1800	200
1	I	4000	Narrow	10	----------	1000-4000	500
1	I	6000	Narrow	10	----------	1500-6000	500
1	II	250	Wide	8	----------	50-200	25
1	II	500	Wide	10	----------	100-500	50
1	II	1000	Wide	11	----------	250-1000	50
2	I	50	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40 or 19/38	---------	---
2	I	125	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40	---------	---
2	I	250	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40	---------	---
2	I	500	Taper-ground joint	------	24/40	---------	---
2	II	25	Taper-ground joint	------	16	---------	---
2	II	50	Taper-ground joint	------	19	---------	---
2	II	125	Taper-ground joint	------	22	---------	---
2	II	250	Taper-ground joint	------	27	---------	---
2	II	500	Taper-ground joint	------	32	---------	---
2	II	1000	Taper-ground joint	------	32	---------	---
2	III	125	Taper-ground joint	------	22	---------	---
2	III	250	Taper-ground joint	------	22	---------	---
2	III	500	Taper-ground joint	------	22	---------	---

3.2.3.5 Type V. Filtering flasks shall be heavy walled, similar in shape to Erlenmeyer flasks with a serrated side arm extending from the neck of the filtering flask. Mouth of flask shall accomodate rubber stoppers as shown in table IV.

TABLE IV. Rubber stopper size for type V filtering flasks

Capacity, ml	Takes rubber stopper size
25	3
50	4
125	5
250	6
500	7
1000	8
2000	9
4000	12
500*	7

* Does not have a side arm.

3.2.3.6 Type VI. Kjeldahl flasks shall be round bottom with a long neck terminating in a beaded rim. Dimensions and rubber stopper requirements shall be as shown in table V.

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TABLE V. Dimensions and rubber stopper sizes of type VI Kjeldahl flasks

Capacity, ml	Height, mm	Takes rubber stopper size
10	178 ± 3	00
30	178 ± 3	0 or 1
100	210 ± 4	1 or 2
500	320 ± 6	*
800	365 ± 6	*

* Necks to accept the rubber stoppers especially designed for Kjeldahl flasks.

3.2.4 Area for marking. Each flask, except type II, shall have an area on one side roughened by blasting or spot-enameled to provide a suitable area for laboratory marking. The area shall show no change or removal of enamel, as applicable, when tested as specified in 4.6.1.

3.3 Annealing. Ring strain shall be no greater than that of the standard reference disc No. 1 when tested as specified in 4.6.2. Any longitudinal strain, if present, shall be faint and highly diffused.

3.4 Identification marking. Each flask shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark. Flask capacity may be marked.

3.5 Workmanship. All flasks shall be transparent and free from striae, surface irregularities, and other imperfections which might distort the appearance of the liquid surface or the portion of the graduation line seen through the glass. The flasks shall be free of blisters, boils, seeds, stones, chips, cracks, and any other defects which would weaken the glass, or impair the serviceability of the flasks. Types I, IV, and VI flasks and the bulb portion of types III and V shall be symmetrical in shape.

3.6 Terminology. All glass terms will be defined by ASTM C 162.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Special provisions.

4.2.1 Alternative inspection (including testing) procedures. The supplier may utilize any alternative inspection procedure which will assure equal or better quality by submitting a written proposal with justification and obtaining written approval from the Government prior to instituting the procedure. In case of dispute, the procedure of this specification will govern.

4.2.2 Supplemental evidence. The supplier shall provide evidence acceptable to the contracting officer that the requirements of 3.1.1, 3.2.1.2, and section 5 have been satisfied.

4.3 Lotting. A lot shall consist of the flasks of the same respective type, class, style, and size offered for acceptance at one time, which has been produced by one manufacturer under essentially the same manufacturing conditions.

4.4 Sampling.

4.4.1 For nondestructive examination. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.2 For test. A sample of 3 flasks shall be taken at random from each 100 flasks or fraction thereof in the lot. Each flask in the sample shall be tested as specified in 4.6.2 prior to testing as specified in 4.6.1. A different 1/3 of the sample shall be tested as specified in 4.6.1.1, 4.6.1.2.1, and 4.6.1.2.2, respectively.

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4.5 Examination.

4.5.1 Examination of end item. Samples of flasks shall be examined in accordance with the factory classification of defects in 4.5.1 and with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1.1 Flasks.

Categories	Defects
Critical:	None defined.
Major:	AQL 4.0 percent defective.
101	Shape not as specified.
102	Dimensions (distance measurements) not as specified.
103	Glass stopper, as required, not as specified.
104	Glass joints, as required, not as specified.
105	Rubber stopper requirement not as specified.
106	Damaged (broken, cracked, checked, chipped, bubbles, etc.).
107	Identification marking illegible, incorrect, or missing.
108	Graduation marking not as specified.

4.5.1.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table VI. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective.

TABLE VI. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Containers	Not as specified.
Contents	Not as specified.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of containers. Cushioning inadequate; improper or missing.

4.5.1.2.1 Examination for closure, waterproofing, and banding of shipping containers. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure, waterproofing and banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of that specification.

4.6 Tests. Distilled water and reagent grade chemicals shall be used throughout the tests. Where applicable, blank determination shall be run and corrections applied where significant. Tests shall be conducted as follows:

4.6.1 Permanency of marking. A different marking area shall be used for each of the following tests.

4.6.1.1 Resistance to alkali. The marking shall be completely immersed in 1N sodium hydroxide solution at room temperature, covered, boiled for 1/2 hour, and allowed to stand in the alkali for an additional 1 hour. The marking shall then be removed, thoroughly rinsed with distilled water, and dried by rubbing vigorously with a cloth.

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4.6.1.2 Resistance to acid.

4.6.1.2.1 Hydrochloric acid. The marking shall be completely immersed in concentrated hydrochloric acid (specific gravity 1.18) at room temperature, covered, boiled for 1/2 hour, and allowed to stand in the acid for an additional 1-1/2 hours. The marking shall then be removed, thoroughly rinsed with distilled water, and dried by rubbing vigorously with a cloth.

4.6.2 Annealing. Flasks shall be tested in accordance with method A or B of ASTM C 148.

4.7 Acceptance/rejection criteria. If any flask fails to meet the test requirements of this specification, the lot represented shall be rejected.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each flask with or without a stopper (see 3.2.1.2) shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size conforming to PPP-B-566, variety 1, PPP-B-676, variety 1, or PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be provided with paperboard or fiberboard blocking or sufficient cushioning material to prevent shifting of or damage to contents. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the appropriate box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. The number of flasks of one description as specified in table VII, shall be packaged in a fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be provided with full height fiberboard partitions to provide a separate cell for each flask. The partitions shall provide a clearance of at least 3/8-inch between the top of the flask and the inside of the box. The glass stoppers, when required (see 3.2.1.2), shall be wrapped or cushioned to prevent damage to the flasks and included in the cell with each flask.

5.1.3 Level C. Flasks shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving agency.

TABLE VII. Packaging and packing quantities

Type	Class	Style	Cap. ml.	No. of flasks in unit packages	No. of unit packages in shipping container	No. of flasks in shipping container
I	1	I	250	12	8	96
			500	6	12	72
			1000	6	6	36
			3000	1	12	12
I	1	II	500	6	6	36
			1000	2	18	36
I	1	III	125	1	12	12
			250	1	12	12
I	2	I	25	12	9	108
			50	12	8	96
			100	12	7	84
			200	12	7	84
			500	6	8	48
I	2	II	500	6	5	30
			1000	2	18	36
			2000	1	18	18
I	2	III	50	1	6	6
			100*	2	6	12
			250	2	6	12
			500	2	6	12
			1000	2	6	12
			2000	2	6	12
I	2	IV	50	2	6	12
			100	2	6	12

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TABLE VII. Packaging and packing quantities (con)

Type	Class	Style	Cap. ml.	No. of flasks in unit packages	No. of unit packages in shipping container	No. of flasks in shipping container
II						18
III	1	I	25	2	12	24
			50	2	12	24
			125	12	2	24
			250	2	12	24
			500	1	18	18
			1000	1	12	12
III	1	II	100	12	2	24
			250	12	2	24
			300	2	9	18
			500	2	6	12
III	2			1	4	4
IV	1	I	25	12	4	48
			50	12	4	48
			125	12	4	48
			250	12	4	48
			500	6	6	36
			1000	6	4	24
			2000	1	8	8
			4000	1	4	4
			6000	1	4	4
IV	1	II	250	12	4	48
			500	6	6	36
			1000	6	4	24
IV	2	I	50	2	6	12
			125	2	6	12
			250	2	6	12
			500	2	6	12
IV	2	II	10	2	6	12
			25	2	6	12
			50	2	6	12
			125	2	6	12
			250	2	6	12
			500	2	4	8
			1000	1	6	6
IV	2	III	125	2	6	12
			250	2	4	8
			500	2	3	6
V			25	2	9	18
			50	2	9	18
			125	2	9	18
			250	2	9	18
			500**	2	9	18
			1000	2	6	12
			2000	1	12	12
			4000	1	6	6
VI			10	6	3	18
			30	6	3	18
			100	6	4	24
			500	6	4	24
			800	6	3	18

* with or without a long neck.
** with or without side arm.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Flasks shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, grade V2s. As far as practical, exterior containers shall be of uniform size and shape, be of minimum cube and tare, and contain identical quantities of like items. Gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. The box shall be closed, waterproofed, and banded in accordance with PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Civil agencies. Flasks, packaged as specified in 5.1, in the quantity specified in table VII, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2.2 Military agencies. Flasks shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1, except that shipping containers shall conform to PPP-B-636, grade V3c. The box shall be closed, waterproofed, and banded in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Flasks shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at first domestic destination. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking. The unit and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 for civil agencies or MIL-STD-129 for military agencies, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The flasks covered by this specification are intended for various laboratory uses.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, style, and capacity required, as applicable (see 1.2.1).
(c) Whether stopper is required (see 3.2.1.2).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Number of flasks to unit package and shipping containers (see 5.1.2, 5.2.2.1, and table VII).
(f) Marking document required (see 5.3).

6.3 Illustration. Figure 1 is for convenience of identification and not meant to limit procurement of flasks.

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 35 cents each.

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